Health Services Request (DS5551)

Fillable working copy, with a plain-language guide

READ THIS FIRST

This is a fillable working copy that captures everything the official DS5551 asks. It opens and fills on any phone, tablet, or computer. It is NOT an official Government of Alberta form.

The official form is on the government's forms site at **cfr.forms.gov.ab.ca/form/DS5551.pdf**. It only opens in Adobe Acrobat Reader on a computer. On a phone or in a web browser, it shows a message saying it needs Adobe Reader.

Before you send this copy, ask your worker: **"Will you accept this working copy of DS5551?"** If they say no, ask them to email or mail you the official form.

What this form is for

Your AISH Health Benefits Card covers prescription drugs, dental, optical, diabetic supplies and ambulance services. This form is how you ask AISH to cover a health service the card does not normally cover. The form lists four services by name, plus a box for anything else:

- Acupuncture
- Chiropractic
- Massage Therapy
- Physiotherapy
- Other (you name it, and the health professional explains it)

The form asks a doctor or other health professional to explain why the service is essential, what happens to your health without it, what else has been tried, and how much it is expected to help.

About the form itself

Form number	DS5551
Official title	Health Services Request
Version	Rev. 2024-04 (printed in the form's footer). This working copy was built from that version.
Security label	Protected B (when completed). That is the government's label for sensitive personal information. Treat your filled-in copy the same way: don't post it or send it to anyone but your worker.
Program	The form is written for AISH. It says "AISH" throughout because it was made before ADAP started on July 2, 2026. If you're on ADAP, ask your worker whether you use this form too.
Where it lives	On the government's forms site only. It is not on the forms list in the old AISH policy manual (last saved December 28, 2025), and the new Disability Income Assistance policy manual (July 2, 2026) has no forms page at all. People find it by searching Google.
Archived copies	The Internet Archive's Wayback Machine saved copies on May 2, 2025 and August 1, 2025.

Privacy law named	The form says your information is collected under the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped Act and the FOIP Act. Alberta replaced the FOIP Act on June 11, 2025 with the Access to Information Act and the Protection of Privacy Act. The form has not been updated to say so.
Pages	The official form is 2 pages. This working copy is longer because the boxes are bigger, so they are easier to fill in on a phone.

Who fills in what

Four people fill in parts of this form. Pass it along in this order.

Section	Who fills it in	What it covers
1	You (or your guardian)	Your name, address, AISH file number, health number, birth date
2	You (or your representative), plus a witness	Your permission for your health care provider to share information with AISH, and for AISH to talk to them
3	A doctor or other health professional who is NOT giving the treatment	Which service, your condition, why it's essential, what else was tried, the evidence, the expected improvement
4	That same doctor or health professional	Their name, address, phone, licence number and signature
5	You (or your representative), plus a witness	Your permission for the treatment provider to share information with AISH
6	The person giving the treatment (for example, your massage therapist)	The treatment goal, how progress will be measured, home exercises, cost, how often and for how long
7	That same treatment provider	Their name, address, phone, licence number and signature

Before you start

- **Get a treatment plan.** The form says you must get a separate treatment plan from the person giving the treatment, "including cost, frequency, duration, and expected outcome." Send it with the form.
- **Use two different health professionals.** Section 3 has to be filled in by someone who is NOT giving the treatment, usually your family doctor. Section 6 is filled in by the person who is.
- **Line up a witness.** Sections 2 and 5 each ask for a witness's name, date and signature.
- **Fill in every section.** The form says: "Incomplete forms cannot be processed."
- **Signing on a phone:** use your phone's Fill and Sign or Markup tool, or print the form and sign it by hand.

Words on this form, explained

- **Authorized Representative:** Someone with legal authority to act for you, like a guardian or trustee. Section 2 asks where their authority comes from.
- **Health Information Act, section 34:** The part of Alberta's health privacy law that lets your health care provider share your health information when you give written consent.

- **Revoke:** To take back your permission. The form says you can revoke your consent at any time, but doing so "will end the process for requesting this health service."
- **Expiry date:** An optional end date for your permission. If you leave it blank, the form says your consent lasts until AISH decides your request.
- **Objective and subjective evidence:** Objective means things that can be measured or seen, like exam findings and test results. Subjective means what you report, like your pain and how your days go.
- **Substantial short-term deterioration:** Your health getting noticeably worse, soon, if you don't get the service.

How AISH decides, and what we don't know yet

The form itself asks the questions AISH uses: is the service essential, will your health get worse without it, what else has been tried, what the evidence is, and whether the improvement will be substantial and lasting.

The current Disability Income Assistance policy manual does not name massage, physiotherapy, chiropractic or acupuncture anywhere. The closest published rule is the page called "Requesting Additional Personal Benefits." It says a need must be shown, that no other resource is available, that the benefit "would significantly assist in managing their disability," that "not providing the benefit would be detrimental to health," and that the least costly option is used. That page also says: "These decisions are not appealable."

Not confirmed: whether that rule is the one AISH uses for this form. The form doesn't say, and the manual doesn't name the form. Ask your worker in writing which rule applies to your request.

The form also does not say where to send it. Send it to your own AISH or ADAP worker or office. Office contacts are on the government's page at **alberta.ca/contact-aish-and-adap**. Keep a copy of everything you send, with the date, and ask for the decision in writing.

Do not send this form to ADSB. It goes to the government, not to us. We don't collect or see anything you type into this file. Questions about filling it in can go to albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com, without your personal information attached.

Sources: Government of Alberta form DS5551 Rev. 2024-04 (cfr.forms.gov.ab.ca/form/DS5551.pdf, archived August 1, 2025); Disability Income Assistance Policy Manual pages "Requesting Additional Health Benefits and Health Benefits Exception Committee (HBEC)" and "Requesting Additional Personal Benefits" (manuals.alberta.ca/dia-policy-manual), checked October 17, 2026; archived AISH Policy Manual forms page (December 28, 2025); Office of the Information and Privacy Commissioner of Alberta, Access to Information Act page.

Health Services Request

DS5551 (Rev. 2024-04), fillable working copy

The personal information provided on this form is collected under the authority of the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped Act, and the Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy (FOIP) Act, and managed in accordance with the FOIP Act. The information will be used for the purpose of assessing eligibility for the health service requested on this form. If you have any questions about the collection of this information, please contact your AISH worker.

Section 1 AISH Client Information

To be completed by the AISH client or guardian on behalf of AISH client.

Last Name

First Name

AISH File Number

Address

City or Town

Province

Postal Code

Alberta Personal Health Number

Date of Birth (Year / Month / Day)

Gender:

- ◯ Female
- ◯ Male

Section 2 Authority to Release Information

To be completed by the individual consenting to the release of information.

I, (Name)

◯ AISH Client

◯ Authorized Representative

☐ authorize my individually identifying health information related to the condition for which I am requesting this health service to be disclosed by my Health Care Provider in accordance with section 34 of the Health Information Act to the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) program for the purpose of assessing eligibility for the health service requested on this form.

☐ give consent to AISH to discuss my need for the health service requested with the Health Care Provider completing this form.

I understand that these consents shall remain valid until AISH determines my eligibility for the requested health service. I have been informed of the risks and benefits of consenting or refusing to consent to the disclosure of my health information. I am aware that I may revoke this consent at any time and that such action will end the process for requesting this health service.

Date and effective as of (day, month, year)

Expiry date (if any)

Name of Client/Authorized Representative

Date (yyyy-mm-dd)

Signature of Client/Authorized Representative

Source of Representative's Authority (e.g. Guardian)

Witness Name

Date (yyyy-mm-dd)

Signature of Witness

Section 3 Request Information

To be completed by Physician or other health professional NOT INVOLVED in providing the requested health service. The client must obtain a separate treatment plan (including cost, frequency, duration, and expected outcome) from the health professional providing the requested health service.

Check appropriate box and answer questions.

- ◯ Acupuncture
- ◯ Chiropractic
- ◯ Massage Therapy
- ◯ Physiotherapy
- ◯ Other - Please Specify

Other - please specify

What medical condition will be treated by the provision of this service? How long has the individual had this condition?

Limit: 900 characters

Is this service essential to treat the individual's condition? Why is it essential?

Limit: 900 characters

If the service is not provided will it result in substantial short-term deterioration in the individual's health? If yes, why? Provide a detailed explanation as to why short term deterioration will occur.

Limit: 900 characters

What alternative services are available and have been tried? What was the response when alternative services were tried? Name all alternatives available services/treatments and when they were tried and a detailed explanation of the response.

Limit: 900 characters

What objective and subjective evidence is available to support the need for the service for this individual? This should include findings from a physical exam and results of any investigations. Provide detailed information regarding the objective and subjective information available.

Limit: 900 characters

Will there be a substantial and sustained improvement in the individual's functioning and/or symptom management? If yes, how will this improvement be measured? How long is the effect of this service expected to last? Provide detailed information as to the expected improvement and duration of the effect.

Limit: 900 characters

Section 4 Physician or Other Health Professional Information

Name

Address

City or Town

Province

Postal Code

Phone

College License or Permit Number

Date (yyyy-mm-dd)

Signature

Section 5 Consent to Release of Information from Service Provider

I, (Name)

◯ AISH Client

◯ Authorized Representative

authorize (Service Provider)

to release information for the health service requested. The information will be relevant to and used solely for the purpose of assessing my eligibility for the health service requested, as a benefit provided through the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) program.

Date and effective as of (day, month, year)

Expiry date (if any)

Name of Client/Authorized Representative

Date (yyyy-mm-dd)

Signature of Client/Authorized Representative

Source of Representative's Authority (e.g. Guardian)

Witness Name

Date (yyyy-mm-dd)

Signature of Witness

Section 6 Request Information - Service Provider

To be completed by health professional providing the requested health service.

Check appropriate box and answer questions.

- ◯ Acupuncture
- ◯ Chiropractic
- ◯ Massage Therapy
- ◯ Physiotherapy
- ◯ Other - Please Specify

Other - please specify

What medical condition will be treated?

Limit: 600 characters

What is the goal or intended outcome of this treatment? How will this be achieved?

Limit: 900 characters

What is the client's present state and how will improvements be measured? Please use objective measurements.

Limit: 900 characters

Does the treatment plan include a home exercise and a transition to self-management component? Please explain.

Limit: 900 characters

What is the cost per treatment? What is the frequency of treatment? How long will treatment be required?

Limit: 600 characters

Additional comments:

Limit: 600 characters

Section 7 Health Service Provider

Name

Address

City or Town

Province

Postal Code

Phone

College License or Permit Number

Date (yyyy-mm-dd)

Signature

Please ensure that all the sections of this form are completed. Incomplete forms cannot be processed.